SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

18 March 2020 · Shift 2

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 25 questions

Q.1

Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case there is no improvement select 'No improvement'. Priya has been working in this school "from June 2017" .

(A) since June 2017
(B) for June 2017
(C) on June 2017
(D) No improvement

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. KIT

(A) Equipment
(B) Information
(C) Element
(D) Particle

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the idiom. Touch all bases

(A) Force someone to do something
(B) Include everything
(C) Stretch your hands high
(D) Imagine you are flying

Q.4

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. VERSATILE

(A) Honest
(B) Inflexible
(C) Insincere
(D) Truthful

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. The Great Stupa at Sanchi is one of the oldest stone structures in India. It was originally commissioned (1)_____ Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE. Its nucleus (2)_____ a simple hemispherical brick structure built (3)_____ the relics of the Buddha. It was crowned by the chhatri, a parasol-like (4)_____ symbolising high rank, which was (5)_____ to honour and shelter the relics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1.

(A) with
(B) by
(C) from
(D) to

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. The Great Stupa at Sanchi is one of the oldest stone structures in India. It was originally commissioned (1)_____ Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE. Its nucleus (2)_____ a simple hemispherical brick structure built (3)_____ the relics of the Buddha. It was crowned by the chhatri, a parasol-like (4)_____ symbolising high rank, which was (5)_____ to honour and shelter the relics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2.

(A) gave
(B) kept
(C) was
(D) were

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. The Great Stupa at Sanchi is one of the oldest stone structures in India. It was originally commissioned (1)_____ Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE. Its nucleus (2)_____ a simple hemispherical brick structure built (3)_____ the relics of the Buddha. It was crowned by the chhatri, a parasol-like (4)_____ symbolising high rank, which was (5)_____ to honour and shelter the relics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3.

(A) aside
(B) about
(C) into
(D) over

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. The Great Stupa at Sanchi is one of the oldest stone structures in India. It was originally commissioned (1)_____ Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE. Its nucleus (2)_____ a simple hemispherical brick structure built (3)_____ the relics of the Buddha. It was crowned by the chhatri, a parasol-like (4)_____ symbolising high rank, which was (5)_____ to honour and shelter the relics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4.

(A) bridge
(B) conduit
(C) structure
(D) wall

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. The Great Stupa at Sanchi is one of the oldest stone structures in India. It was originally commissioned (1)_____ Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE. Its nucleus (2)_____ a simple hemispherical brick structure built (3)_____ the relics of the Buddha. It was crowned by the chhatri, a parasol-like (4)_____ symbolising high rank, which was (5)_____ to honour and shelter the relics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5.

(A) informed
(B) predicted
(C) intended
(D) outlined

Q.10

Select the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error. Oh dear! The audio in one of the channel on television is not clear at all.

(A) on television
(B) Oh dear! The audio
(C) in one of the channel
(D) is not clear at all

Q.11

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. ANODYNE

(A) Harmful
(B) Benign
(C) Hostile
(D) Gigantic

Q.12

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order. A. Mulla Nasruddin opened a hair-cutting salon and was ready to welcome his customers. B. “Mulla,” he said sheepishly, “my new wife is coming home today.” C. “Just take out all the grey strands from my beard and make me look very young.” D. Being the first day, a lot of people came and among them was a man in his early fifties with a flowing beard.

(A) BDAC
(B) CDAB
(C) ADBC
(D) DBCA

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. NEBULOUS

(A) Common
(B) Familiar
(C) Clear
(D) Mutual

Q.14

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Small room where dishes are washed

(A) Ante-room
(B) Pantry
(C) Larder
(D) Scullery

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Earthquake inspection _____ that the two ancient buildings that remained intact after the Hiroshima bombing in Tokyo would not withstand a strong tremor.

(A) retracted
(B) resumed
(C) redirected
(D) revealed

Q.16

Select the word with the correct spelling.

(A) Impresionable
(B) Impeccable
(C) Suceptible
(D) Propencity

Q.17

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. The police was able to find the guilty but “the big fish” escaped.

(A) plump men
(B) large-sized ones
(C) tall people
(D) main leaders

Q.18

Select the option that is the direct form of the sentence. Kirti asked me if I had watched the movie on television the previous night.

(A) Kirti asked me, “You had watched the movie on television last night?”
(B) Kirti asked me, “Had you watched the movie on television last night?”
(C) Kirti asked me, “Did you watch the movie on television last night?”
(D) Kirti asked me, “Did I watched the movie on television last night?”

Q.19

Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case there is no improvement select 'No improvement'. The struggle for climate change "must be prioritised" given that our population is increasing and not decreasing.

(A) could prioritise
(B) may have prioritised
(C) is prioritising
(D) No improvement

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The reporter asked the politician, "As a woman leader, what are some of the major _____ that you face?"

(A) challenges
(B) crunches
(C) contests
(D) crashes

Q.21

Select the option that is the passive form of the sentence. The batsman had hit the ball towards the boundary.

(A) The ball is hit towards the boundary by the batsman.
(B) The ball is being hit towards the boundary by the batsman.
(C) The ball was hit towards the boundary by the batsman.
(D) The ball had been hit towards the boundary by the batsman.

Q.22

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Person or thing that is the centre of attention

(A) Organiser
(B) Politician
(C) Cynosure
(D) Leader

Q.23

Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error. It is difficult to make out that they are twins because they do not resemble to each other.

(A) because they do not
(B) that they are twins
(C) It is difficult to make out
(D) resemble to each other

Q.24

Select the word with the INCORRECT spelling.

(A) Medetative
(B) Apprehensive
(C) Appended
(D) Pensive

Q.25

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order. A. Waqar instead gave it to Afridi, who went on to score a 37-ball century, the fastest ODI century. B. That was when his teammate Waqar Younis handed him over a bat that belonged to Sachin Tendulkar. C. When Shahid Afridi had flown in to join the Pakistan team 1996, he did not even have a proper bat to play with. D. Sachin had earlier gifted Waqar his bat to take to Sialkot, Pakistan's world famous sports goods manufacturing capital and get a custom-made one replicated there.

(A) ACBD
(B) CBDA
(C) DCAB
(D) BADC

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1
Which among the following financial institutions was nationalised in 1949?

(A) RBI
(B) SIDBI
(C) PNB
(D) IFCI

Q.2
Which of the following activities can be classified as a part of secondary sector of an economy?

(A) Legal consulting
(B) Tea plantation
(C) Farm equipment manufacturing
(D) Banking

Q.3
In which of the following states is the Phodong monastery situated?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Bihar
(C) Arunachal Pradesh
(D) Sikkim

Q.4
Which of the following nations won the inaugural ATP Cup tennis tournament in January 2020?

(A) Germany
(B) Switzerland
(C) Serbia
(D) Spain

Q.5
Who has been appointed the Director General of the National Security Guard (NSG) in October 2019?

(A) Utkarsh Jain
(B) BPS Yadav
(C) Awadhesh Pratap Singh
(D) Anup Kumar Singh

Q.6
Which one of the following nations finished the year 2019 as the top shooting nation in the world as per the International Shooting Sport Federation's (ISSF) overall rankings for 2019?

(A) Russia
(B) India
(C) USA
(D) China

Q.7
The 2019 Nobel Peace Prize has been awarded to the Ethiopian Prime Minister, Abiy Ahmed Ali, particularly for his efforts to resolve border dispute with:

(A) Somalia
(B) Eritrea
(C) Sudan
(D) Kenya

Q.8
Who among the following was chosen as the Time Magazine's 2019 Person of the year?

(A) Donald Trump
(B) Malala Yousafzai
(C) Greta Thunberg
(D) Narendra Modi

Q.9
Which of the following is an input device that utilises a light-sensitive detector to select objects on a display screen?

(A) Light pen
(B) Bar code reader
(C) Optical mark recognition (OMR)
(D) Magnetic ink character recognition (MICR)

Q.10

Which of the following nations 'unintentionally' shot down a Ukrainian Boeing 737-800 passenger aircraft in January 2020?

(A) Iran
(B) Saudi Arabia
(C) Iraq
(D) Syria

Q.11

What was the focal theme of the 107th Indian Science Congress held at Bengaluru in January 2020?

(A) Science and Technology: Rural Development
(B) Science and Technology: Urban Development
(C) Science and Technology: Water Resources Development
(D) Science and Technology: Renewable Energy Development

Q.12

Which of the following statements about Sambhar lake is true?

(A) It is the highest lake in India.
(B) It was formed due to hypervelocity impact of a comet.
(C) It drains into the Arabian sea.
(D) It is the largest inland salt lake in India.

Q.14

Which among the following is the oldest mountain/hill range in India?

(A) Himalayas
(B) Aravalli Hills
(C) Eastern Ghats
(D) Western Ghats

Q.15

Who was the Prime Minister of Britain/UK when British Parliament passed an independence bill for India in July 1947?

(A) Clement Attlee
(B) Neville Chamberlain
(C) Ramsay Macdonald
(D) Winston Churchill

Q.16

The process of impeachment of the President of India can be initiated in:

(A) Rajya Sabha but not in Lok Sabha
(B) either house of the parliament
(C) Lok Sabha but not in Rajya Sabha
(D) Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha or any state legislative assembly

Q.17

The speed of the Central Processing Unit (CPU) is measured in_____, which represents a CPU cycle.

(A) Gigabyte (GB)
(B) Hertz (Hz)
(C) Terabyte (TB)
(D) Kilobyte (KB)

Q.18

Who among the following won ICC's '2019 ODI Cricketer of The Year' award?

(A) David Warner
(B) Steven Smith
(C) Ken Williamson
(D) Rohit Sharma

Q.19

Which of the following crops is an example of Kharif Crops?

(A) Gram
(B) Pea
(C) Wheat
(D) Cotton

Q.20

In which year did Telangana become the 29th state of India?

(A) 2011
(B) 2002
(C) 2004
(D) 2014

Q.21

With which of the following states/union territories is the Dumhal folk dance associated?

(A) Haryana
(B) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
(C) Jammu and Kashmir
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.22

The earthquake waves are recorded by an instrument called:

(A) seismograph
(B) richter scale
(C) speedometer
(D) odometer

Q.23

Which causative microorganism is responsible for the common cold and influenza (flu)?

(A) Viruses
(B) Protozoa
(C) Fungi
(D) Bacteria

Q.24

Which of the following rivers flows into the Bay of Bengal?

(A) Sutlej
(B) Beas
(C) Krishna
(D) Ravi

Q.25

Which among the following states has the highest representation in the Lok Sabha?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (A) since June 2017

With the present perfect continuous 'has been working', 'since' gives the point in time the action started from: 'since June 2017'. 'For' goes with a length of time ('for three years').

Q.2 · Answer (A) Equipment

A kit is a set of tools or equipment for a particular purpose, such as a first-aid kit: 'equipment'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Include everything

To 'touch all bases' is to deal with every part of a matter, leaving nothing out: 'include everything'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Inflexible

'Versatile' means able to adapt to many different uses or tasks; its opposite is 'inflexible'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) by

A work is commissioned 'by' the person who orders it: 'commissioned by Emperor Ashoka'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) was

The singular subject 'Its nucleus' takes the singular past 'was': 'Its nucleus was a simple hemispherical brick structure'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) over

The brick dome was built 'over' the relics of the Buddha, covering them.

Q.8 · Answer (C) structure

The chhatri was a parasol-like 'structure' set on top of the stupa; a bridge, a conduit or a wall is not shaped like a parasol.

Q.9 · Answer (C) intended

Its purpose is given: the chhatri 'was intended to honour and shelter the relics'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) in one of the channel

'One of' is followed by a plural noun: 'in one of the channels'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Benign

'Anodyne' means harmless and unlikely to offend or upset anyone: 'benign'. 'Harmful' and 'hostile' are nearly its opposites.

Q.12 · Answer (C) ADBC

A introduces the new salon, D the crowd on the first day and the bearded man among them, B has him begin to speak and C gives his request: ADBC.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Clear

'Nebulous' means vague or hazy, not clearly defined; its opposite is 'clear'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Scullery

A scullery is a small room next to a kitchen where dishes are washed. A pantry and a larder are for storing food, and an ante-room leads into a larger room.

Q.15 · Answer (D) revealed

An inspection 'revealed', that is brought to light, that the buildings would not withstand a strong tremor.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Impeccable

'Impeccable' is spelt correctly; the others should be 'impressionable', 'susceptible' and 'propensity'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) main leaders

'Big fish' are the important or powerful people in a group: the minor offenders were caught, but the main leaders escaped.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Kirti asked me, “Did you watch the movie on television last night?”
Back in direct speech the reported past perfect 'had watched' becomes the simple past, the tense for one finished action at a stated time such as 'last night' (reported as 'the previous night'). The yes/no question therefore opens with 'Did you': 'Did you watch the movie on television last night?'

Q.19 · Answer (D) No improvement
'Must be prioritised' is a correct passive with 'must', saying the struggle needs to be given priority; the options change the sense or the voice, so no improvement is needed.

Q.20 · Answer (A) challenges
A leader 'faces challenges', difficulties that test their ability; 'crunches', 'contests' and 'crashes' do not fit the sense.

Q.21 · Answer (D) The ball had been hit towards the boundary by the batsman.
The past perfect 'had hit' becomes the past perfect passive 'had been hit': 'The ball had been hit towards the boundary by the batsman.'

Q.22 · Answer (C) Cynosure
A cynosure is a person or thing that is the centre of attention or admiration.

Q.23 · Answer (D) resemble to each other
'Resemble' takes its object directly, without 'to': 'they do not resemble each other'.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Medetative
'Medetative' is misspelt: the word is 'meditative', from 'meditate'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) CBDA
C sets the scene (Afridi joining the team without a proper bat), B says Waqar handed him a bat that was Sachin's, D explains how Waqar had come to have it, and A says what Afridi did with it: CBDA.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) RBI
The Reserve Bank of India, set up in 1935 as a shareholders' bank, was nationalised on 1 January 1949. PNB was nationalised in 1969, IFCI was set up in 1948 and SIDBI in 1990.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Farm equipment manufacturing
The secondary sector turns raw materials into goods, as in manufacturing farm equipment. Tea plantation is primary, and legal consulting and banking are services (tertiary).

Q.3 · Answer (D) Sikkim
Phodong Monastery, a Buddhist monastery, is in North Sikkim.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Serbia
Serbia, led by Novak Djokovic, won the first ATP Cup, beating Spain in the final in Sydney in January 2020.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Anup Kumar Singh
Anup Kumar Singh, an IPS officer, was appointed Director General of the National Security Guard in October 2019.

Q.6 · Answer (B) India
India ended 2019 at the top of the ISSF's overall rankings, after leading the medal tables at that year's rifle and pistol World Cups.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Eritrea
Abiy Ahmed received the 2019 Nobel Peace Prize for his work for peace, and above all for his initiative to end the long border conflict with neighbouring Eritrea.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Greta Thunberg
The Swedish climate activist Greta Thunberg, then 16, was Time magazine's Person of the Year for 2019, the youngest chosen up to then.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Light pen
A light pen is a pen-shaped pointing device with a light-sensitive detector in its tip, used to select objects or draw on a display screen.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Iran
Iran's forces shot down Ukraine International Airlines Flight 752, a Boeing 737-800, soon after it took off from Tehran on 8 January 2020; Iran later admitted it had done so unintentionally.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Science and Technology: Rural Development
The 107th Indian Science Congress, held at the University of Agricultural Sciences, Bengaluru, in January 2020, had the theme 'Science and Technology: Rural Development'.

Q.12 · Answer (D) It is the largest inland salt lake in India.
Sambhar Lake in Rajasthan is the largest inland salt lake in India. It has no outlet to the sea, and it is Lonar Lake in Maharashtra that was formed by a meteorite impact.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Aravalli Hills
The Aravallis are the oldest fold mountains in India, worn down over a very long time; the Himalayas are among the youngest mountains in the world.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Clement Attlee
The Indian Independence Act was passed by the British Parliament in July 1947, when Clement Attlee of the Labour Party was Prime Minister.

Q.16 · Answer (B) either house of the parliament
Under Article 61 the charge for impeaching the President may be brought by either House of Parliament, and the other House investigates it. State legislatures have no part in impeachment.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Hertz (Hz)
A CPU's clock speed is measured in hertz, cycles per second, usually given in megahertz or gigahertz. Kilobytes, gigabytes and terabytes measure storage.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Rohit Sharma
Rohit Sharma, who scored five centuries at the 2019 World Cup, was named the ICC's ODI Cricketer of the Year for 2019 in January 2020.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Cotton
Cotton is sown at the start of the south-west monsoon and harvested in autumn, a kharif crop. Gram, pea and wheat are rabi crops, sown in winter.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 2014
Telangana was carved out of Andhra Pradesh and became India's 29th state on 2 June 2014.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Jammu and Kashmir
Dumhal is a folk dance of Kashmir, performed by men of the Wattal community.

Q.22 · Answer (A) seismograph
A seismograph records the waves of an earthquake. The Richter scale is not an instrument but a scale for an earthquake's magnitude.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Viruses
The common cold and influenza are viral infections, caused mainly by rhinoviruses and influenza viruses respectively.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Krishna

The Krishna flows east across the Deccan into the Bay of Bengal. The Sutlej, Beas and Ravi belong to the Indus system, which drains into the Arabian Sea.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Uttar Pradesh

Uttar Pradesh had 80 Lok Sabha seats when the exam was held (March 2020), the most of any state, against 39 for Tamil Nadu and 25 each for Rajasthan and Andhra Pradesh.

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